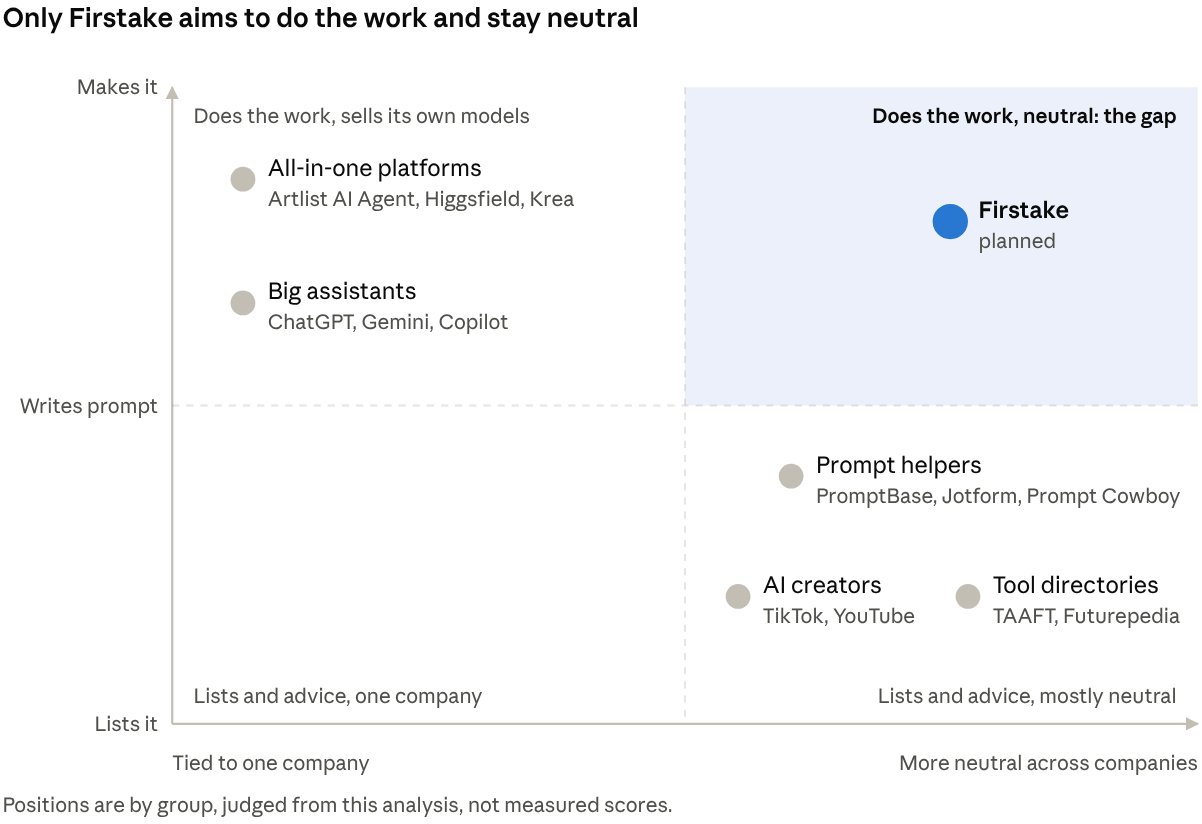
Firstake Competitor Analysis

Oct 26, 2026 · @zara

Firstake's competitors each do one part of its job: directories list tools, prompt helpers write prompts, all-in-one platforms and big assistants generate media, and TikTok creators give advice. None combines neutral, cross-company tool choice with prices per output and prompts written in each tool's own language. The closest rival is the Artlist AI Agent (May 2026), which recommends models and writes prompts, but only for the models Artlist sells.

Market map



market map · 5 competitor groups by neutrality and how much they do

The groups that do the most work (generate media, write prompts) are tied to the models they sell; the neutral ones only list tools or give advice. The top-right corner is empty, and that is Firstake's target.

1. AI tool directories

Directories are the closest competitors to Firstake's routing half, and they have a big head start in size. But they stop at "here is a list": none of the large ones writes the prompt, compares cost per output, or tells a beginner what to do next. Their size is also their weakness; reviewers describe them as overwhelming without a precise search, with uneven listing quality (Fast.io, AI Indigo).

Directory	Size	How it ranks tools	Strength	Weakness vs. Firstake
There's An AI For That	12,000 to 54,000+ tools (counts differ by what's included)	Task search, trending lists, leaderboards; has advertising and paid submission pages	Largest and best-known; describe-a-task search	No prompts, no cost comparison; popularity can reflect marketing spend
Futurepedia	5,000+ tools, 54 categories	Editorial	Video tutorials, 2M+ YouTube subscribers, courses	Leans to marketing tools; teaching, not doing
Toolify	26,000+ tools, 450+ categories	Usage, saves, revenue	Deepest categories	Thin listings, cluttered
FutureTools	4,000+ tools	Community upvotes	Clean, weekly updates, AI news	No detailed reviews
TopAI.tools	19,000+	Keyword search	Fast search	No reviews or editorial depth
ToolDirectory.ai	~2,200, curated	Manual review with dates; side-by-side pricing comparison	Freshness dates, tracks discontinued tools	Small catalog; still no prompts
RankmyAI	63,000+	Score from traffic, reviews, funding	Transparent method	Favors big, established tools

What to learn from them: ToolDirectory.ai's "review date on every listing" and "graveyard of discontinued tools" match Firstake's last-verified rule and should be visible to users. **What to avoid:** paid placement shaping rankings, which is exactly the trust problem Firstake's neutrality rules solve.

Size figures are self-reported by the directories and come from rival publishers' reviews, so treat them as approximate.

2. Prompt helpers

Prompt helpers compete with Firstake's prompt-writing half, but each assumes the user has already picked the right tool. Most are built for text chatbots; few handle video or music, and none chooses the tool or compares prices.

Prompt marketplaces and libraries

Tool	What it is	Price	Weakness vs. Firstake
PromptBase	Marketplace to buy and sell prompts for ChatGPT, Gemini, Midjourney and others; lists 270,000+ prompts	Free to browse; prompts sold individually	Uneven quality; one-size prompts need rewriting for your project; costs add up (Enterprise DNA)
PromptHero	Free searchable library of prompts and example images	Free	No testing or editing; copies someone else's idea instead of yours (Enterprise DNA)
GitHub prompt libraries (awesome-gpt-image and similar)	Community prompt collections	Free	Raw, technical, often contain real people and brands; some are mostly empty

Prompt generators and optimizers (Jotform review)

Tool	Media covered	Price	Weakness vs. Firstake
Jotform AI Prompt Generator	Text + images (Midjourney, Flux, Stable Diffusion, DALL-E)	Free	No video or music; you must already know which model you're using
Feedough Prompt Generator	Text, Midjourney, separate video tool	Free	Split into separate tools; refinement stops after three questions

Tool	Media covered	Price	Weakness vs. Firstake
Prompt Cowboy	Text, with image and video prompt types	Free 10/month; from ~$8–11/month	Beta; no tool choice or testing
PromptHub, PromptLayer, Arize	Text only, for developers and teams	Free tiers; $9–50/month	Business prompt management, not creative help

Built-in prompt enhancers are the quiet threat: Ideogram's magic prompt, Gemini's prompt expansion for Veo, and ChatGPT's own rewriting of image requests already improve prompts inside each tool. But each only improves prompts for its own model, which is the gap Firstake fills: one helper that knows every tool's syntax and picks the tool first.

3. All-in-one platforms

This is the most dangerous group, because they already combine many models with an assistant that helps choose and prompt. The closest single competitor to Firstake is the **Artlist AI Agent** (announced May 2026): a chat assistant that enhances prompts, gives several prompt options, recommends models based on your goal, and tracks your credits (Artlist). Their structural limit is the same for all of them: they can only recommend models they host and sell, and every choice spends their credits.

Platform	What it bundles	Price	Assistant or agent?	Where it's biased
Artlist	Veo, Kling, Seedance, Nano Banana, Sora 2, music, voice, plus stock music and footage with a commercial license	AI Suite from ~$10–13/mo	Yes: AI Agent with prompt help and model recommendations; chatting is free, generations use credits	Only Artlist's models; never sends you to a free option elsewhere

Platform	What it bundles	Price	Assistant or agent?	Where it's biased
Higgsfield	15+ video models plus image	$19 / $59 / $129 per month	"Agentic" creation products launched May 2026	Only its models. Big player: $5.4B valuation, ~$700M annualized revenue, 30M+ users (Pulse 2.0)
Krea	60+ image, video, 3D models; real-time canvas	From $5.25/mo (annual)	Node workflows	Only hosted models
Freepik (Magnific)	Image and video models plus a stock library	$14.50/mo (annual)	Model menu	Pushes its own stock and suite
OpenArt	100+ models, consistent characters	From $14/mo	Model menu	Credit cost varies by model
Poe (Quora)	Many chatbots in one app	Free; $4.99–249.99/mo on a points system	You pick the bot	Points shrank 34% on Premium in July 2026 (Costbench)
OpenRouter	Hundreds of LLMs through one API	Pay per token	No (for developers)	Neutral, but text only and technical

What Firstake must do better than Artlist's agent:

- **Recommend across every platform,** including free tools, school-provided access and the user's existing subscriptions, which no reseller will do.
- **Show the price of each option** next to the free alternative.
- **Cover jobs these platforms don't:** websites, slides, add-on stacks for Claude Code, and beginners who don't know what "image-to-video" means.

Possible partner, not just rival: aggregators are also a smart route. When a user needs several media types, Firstake can honestly recommend Artlist or Krea as the cheapest bundle.

4. General AI assistants

The biggest threat is the simplest one: a user just asks ChatGPT or Gemini. These assistants already make images, write prompts, and increasingly plug in creative apps: Adobe now offers 70+ tools inside ChatGPT, including Photoshop, Premiere, Firefly and Express (PetaPixel). Firstake's answer has to be clear and short.

Assistant	What it does for creative work	Its built-in bias	Gap Firstake fills
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	GPT Image 2 in chat; Adobe and other apps inside ChatGPT; rewrites image prompts for you	Routes to OpenAI's models and partner apps	Never says "Midjourney is better for this" or "Kling's free credits will do"
Gemini (Google)	Nano Banana images, Veo video through Flow, NotebookLM	Routes to Google's models	Won't compare Veo's price with Seedance or Kling
Claude (Anthropic)	Strong writing and code, Claude Code add-ons for web design	No image or video generation	Can't make the media itself
Microsoft Copilot	Designer images, Copilot in PowerPoint	Routes to Microsoft tools	Same single-company limit
Meta AI	Free images inside WhatsApp and Instagram	Meta's models only	Casual use, little control

The pitch answer to "Why not just ask ChatGPT?"

> ChatGPT will always send you to ChatGPT. Firstake sends you to whatever is best and cheapest for your job, including tools you already have for free, and writes the prompt in that tool's own language.

What could close this gap: if an assistant added neutral, cross-company recommendations with live prices. That is unlikely for companies whose revenue depends on keeping users in their own tools, but it is the risk to watch.

5. Human competitors

Today, most people learn which AI tool to use from a person: an AI creator on TikTok or YouTube, a course, or a friend. These are free, trusted and fast to pick up new tools, which makes them Firstake's real everyday competition, and its best marketing channel.

Source	Examples	Strength	Weakness vs. Firstake
TikTok AI creators	@yatesvids ("use Lovable for websites"), @maverickgpt (how to prompt a website that doesn't look AI-made)	Spot new tools and tricks within days; engaging	One video for everyone, not your project; tips expire when models update; some are wrong
YouTube channels and newsletters	Futurepedia (2M+ subscribers), FutureTools / AI news channels	Deeper tutorials	Long; you still have to apply it yourself
Paid courses	Prompting and AI-tools courses	Structured learning	Costly, dated within months
Friends, classmates, colleagues	—	Trusted	Recommend what they happen to use

How to use them:

- **As a research feed:** creators surface new tools and add-ons (like Taste and Impeccable) first, so the catalog update process should watch them, then verify each claim against official docs.
- **As a distribution channel:** a creator showing "I typed my idea into Firstake and it picked Kling and wrote the prompt" is the natural launch video.
- **As the bar to clear:** Firstake has to feel as easy as watching a 30-second video, but personal to the user's project.

6. Feature comparison

Every competitor group covers one or two of these jobs; Firstake is designed to cover all of them in one answer. The "Firstake (planned)" column is the goal, not something built yet.

Feature	Tool directories	Prompt helpers	Artlist AI Agent	ChatGPT / Gemini	TikTok creators	Firstake (planned)
Understands a plain-language goal	Partly (task search)	Yes	Yes	Yes	No (one video for all)	Yes
Picks the right tool	Lists many	No	Only its own models	Only its own company's	Yes, generally	Yes, across every company
Neutral, no paid ranking	Mixed (ads, paid listings)	Yes	No	No	Mixed (sponsorships)	Yes, written rules
Shows price per output	No	No	Its own credits only	No	Sometimes	Yes, best / cheapest / free
Free and school-provided options	Free filters	—	No	No	Sometimes	Yes
Writes the prompt in each tool's syntax	No	Text and images mostly	Yes, for its models	Yes, for its models	Shows examples	Yes, for every tool in the catalog
Asks only what's missing	No	Some (fixed questions)	Yes	Sometimes	No	Yes
Image, video, music, voice, web, slides	Lists all	Mostly text and image	Image and video (music, voice coming)	Image, some video	Depends on creator	All, with media depth
Consistent-character workflow	No	No	Partly	Partly	Sometimes	Yes
Add-on stacks (Claude Code skills)	No	No	No	No	Yes (where Firstake learned them)	Yes

Feature	Tool directories	Prompt helpers	Artlist AI Agent	ChatGPT / Gemini	TikTok creators	Firstake (planned)
Beginner step-by-step help	No	No	Partly	Partly	Yes	Yes
Generates the result itself	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	Demo: one category via API

The last row is where Firstake starts behind: Artlist and ChatGPT already generate the output. That's why the demo should generate at least one image or short video through an API, so judges see an end-to-end working product.

7. Positioning, risks and how Firstake wins

One-line positioning:

> Firstake is a neutral AI creative director: tell it what you want to make, and it picks the best and cheapest tool from any company, writes the prompt in that tool's language, and shows you exactly what to do next.

Three things only Firstake combines

1. **Neutral across companies.** Every platform and assistant recommends its own models; directories rank with ads. Firstake has written neutrality rules and shows the free option every time.
2. **Cost per finished output.** Prices sit next to every pick (per image, per second of video, per song), including free and school-provided access.
3. **Tool-specific prompts, not generic ones.** Midjourney parameters, Suno's separate boxes, Veo's shot formula, the consistent-character workflow and Claude Code add-on stacks, explained at the user's level.

Risks and responses

Risk	Likelihood	Response
Artlist, Higgsfield or Krea add a neutral, cross-platform recommender	Low: it would send customers to rivals	Stay neutral and broader (websites, slides, add-ons)

Risk	Likelihood	Response
ChatGPT or Gemini become "good enough" for most people	Medium	Win on cost savings and tools those companies don't own
Prices and tools change faster than the catalog	High	Monthly update process with scrapers and last-verified dates; flag anything older than 30 days
Neutrality breaks if Firstake takes referral fees	Medium, once it earns money	Disclose fees; never let them change the order
Directories add AI chat on top of their lists	Medium	Their lists are wide but thin; Firstake's depth is the prompt and the cost math

For the judges (rubric fit)

- **Problem (10 pts):** tens of thousands of AI tools exist, users get overwhelmed and waste credits on the wrong ones, and even the best-funded platforms only steer you to their own models.
- **Creativity (20 pts):** no competitor in this analysis combines cross-company neutral routing, cost per output and tool-specific prompting.
- **Demo (35 pts):** show the gap live. Type the same idea into Firstake and show it choose a tool, show three prices, write the prompt, and generate the result.

Sources

- Fast.io: Best AI tool directories 2026
- AI Indigo: Review of There's An AI For That
- Enterprise DNA: PromptBase and PromptHero
- Jotform: Best AI prompt generators 2026
- Artlist: Introducing the Artlist AI Agent
- Pulse 2.0: Higgsfield Series B
- Costbench: Poe pricing
- PetaPixel: Adobe's expanded ChatGPT integration
- Pricing for aggregators comes from the Firstake AI Tool Catalog, sections 8b–8e

Several figures come from rival publishers or single sources and are marked approximate; re-check before quoting them in the pitch.